“Well, at least the Euphrasia worked.” He lifted hands in front of his face, as in a gesture of prayer. “Did you understand what I showed you back there?”

“Maria is with child?”

“Yes. Do you know who the father is?”

“No.”

“I heard you telling her that Tomasz would be coming. Is he the father?”

“I don’t know. She never spoke about him with me. But she was calling his name out just now.”

“I won’t include the pregnancy in her patient report.”

Léa didn’t understand. Wouldn’t he want to include her pregnancy in the report so that the Meister would give her shorter hours, time off, supplemental food coupons? “Shouldn’t you include it so she’ll be better treated?”

“It doesn’t work like that. We keep the baby a secret, to protect it.”

Léa’s throat tightened. “From whom?”

“Tomasz is a Polish name. If he’s the father . . .”

“What?”

“She’ll be sent to a clinic for an abortion.”

“Against her will?”

“Yes.”

Léa grasped the edge of the chair to steady herself, a wave of horror sweeping through her. The idea that Maria’s pregnancy might be forcibly ended was too terrible to imagine. He stepped closer and placed a hand on her shoulder, and she felt his warmth pass though her.

“All we can do is help her hide the pregnancy until the baby’s born. Like you’ve done today by bringing her here. Keep a protective eye on her. After that, it’s in God’s hands.”

She didn’t know what to say. After all she’d experienced—the death of Édouard, the poor dead woman she’d seen in the camp in Jargeau, and the mistreatment of Polish laborers, she wasn’t sure that she believed in God anymore. Maman would never forgive her for thinking such a thing, but if he was so powerful, why didn’t he help the innocent who suffered because of this terrible war? She’d already lost hope in her country and now she was losing her faith.

She looked up at him. “Is there a positive outcome if the father isn’t